

BOOKRUNNER (\$BKRN) — Overview

One line: The underwriting syndicate for on-chain perp markets. Capital allocators subscribe to tranches of a *book*; the book capitalises a market's insurance fund and market-making inventory; agent bookrunners quote and hedge it under a mandate letter enforced in code; the book earns the market's fee flow. Stock perps first, on Robinhood Chain.

Chain: Robinhood Chain (4663). USDC/USDG capital. Markets on Orderly Perp Anything (fast path) and an in-house pool-vs-trader engine (full control). Hedges in canonical Stock Tokens and other perp venues.

Sector: Capital markets / underwriting × perps × RWA × agents.

Leader replicated: Hyperliquid HLP (community-capitalised house vault) + GMX GM pools / Jupiter JLP (LP-is-the-counterparty) + Orderly Perp Anything's builder economics (builder lists a market, funds the insurance fund, keeps 50% of taker fees) + investment-bank syndicate structure (bookrunner, tranches, allocation). **Leader beaten on:** per-market books instead of one blended vault, senior/junior tranches with a real waterfall, permissionless market selection, agent market-makers under on-chain mandates, published book-level P&L and risk, RWA/stock markets with sessions.

Status: Spec v1.0 — 2026-10-01.

Studio reuse ≈ 65%: pool-vs-trader perp engine (Synthetix V3 lineage) with attested multi-source oracle and off-hours regime, deterministic authorization pipeline for agent keys, model-jury for listing decisions, keyless ERC-4626 vault accounting at NAV, Merkle receipts, canonical Stock Token registry for hedge legs. **New:** `Book` with tranche waterfall, `MarketCharter`, Orderly builder adapter (insurance-fund account + fee settlement), `MMMandate` risk limits, risk committee flow. **The 1/1 twist:** anyone can be the house — not of a venue, but of *one market* — with a senior or junior ticket, and the market-maker is an agent that cannot exceed its mandate.

1. Sector state (verified 2026-10-01)

- **Orderly Perp Anything** (docs): individual builders list markets self-serve; builder-operated markets for the same asset get separate symbols and may use builder-controlled price sources; **insurance fund accounts per builder, one per symbol or shared**; when a market's IF is depleted, **ADL applies only to that market**; builder receives **50% of base taker fees** (maker fees, liquidation fees and funding excluded), settled daily; **isolated margin only**; RWA markets with configurable trading sessions;

pre-TGE listings. Prior recon: ~\$25k USDC IF per symbol, omnichain deposits (BNB/Arbitrum/Base). **Orderly sells the builder seat; nobody syndicates it.**

- **Community house vaults:** Hyperliquid HLP is one blended vault across all markets with no tranches and no market choice; GMX/Jupiter pools are LP-as-counterparty with a fixed basket. **No per-market underwriting, no seniority, no agent MMs under on-chain limits.**
- **Equity perps are the growth market:** Binance equity-perp OI > \$2.9B (~105% monthly growth in 2026); equity basis averages $\approx 3.56\%$ annualised over six months; Ethena began allocating to equity basis on 2026-09-25. RWA perps were \$213B in Q2 2026 (prior recon). On Robinhood Chain: Arcus (50x stock perps), Lighter, Meridian; Stock Tokens ~202 names, ~\$42M float, a dozen liquid; Chainlink equity feeds 24/5 that hold off-hours.
- **Agents as market-makers:** venue MM programs are human/firm-based; agentic trading on Robinhood is retail; on-chain agent identity (ERC-8004) and jobs (ERC-8183) exist on RHC with no MM-mandate layer. **No venue lets an agent quote under a limit the venue itself enforces.**
- **Curated risk capital** is a proven allocator behaviour: risk-curator vaults \$6.58B (early 2026), Steakhouse > \$1.8B. Allocators already accept "curator + mandate + waterfall" shapes.

Defensible claim: *"First permissionless underwriting syndicate for perp markets on Robinhood Chain — tranche-capitalised books, agent bookrunners, mandates enforced on-chain."*

2. Why this name

The bookrunner is the bank that runs the book on a deal: sizes it, prices it, allocates it, carries the risk. It is the most "big business" word in capital markets, and nobody in crypto uses it (one dead low-liquidity pair; no protocol). Tagline: *"Run the book."* Vocabulary: **book, syndicate, tranche, allocation, mandate letter, risk committee, close.**

3. What it does

Charter a market. A sponsor (a treasury, a fund, an agent fleet, a KOL syndicate) files a `MarketCharter`: underlying (a canonical Stock Token, an index of Stock Tokens, a pre-listing asset), venue (Orderly Perp Anything or the in-house engine), oracle plan (builder oracle = the studio's attested multi-source TEE oracle; Chainlink where a feed exists), trading sessions, insurance-fund target, MM mandate (max inventory, max skew, min quote width, max leverage on hedge legs, kill conditions), and the tranche terms. The **Risk Committee** — a model-jury verdict plus three bonded human committee members —

approves or rejects within 48 h. Approved charters become **books**.

Subscribe to the book. Each book has two ERC-4626 tranches:

- **Senior** — first claim on fee flow up to a hurdle share, last loss; redeemable at NAV at every daily mark.
- **Junior** — residual fee flow (the upside), first loss; redeemable at NAV with a 7-day notice (notice $\neq$ gate: the redemption is always honoured at the next mark after notice). Allocation is pro-rata with a per-wallet cap during the subscription window; the sponsor must hold $\geq 10\%$ of Junior (skin in the book).

Capitalise the market. The book deposits the insurance fund (per-symbol IF account on Orderly, or the engine's IF on the in-house venue) and the MM inventory (USDC on the venue with trade-only keys; hedge inventory in canonical Stock Tokens on-chain).

Agent bookrunners quote it. Each book has one or more bookrunner agents holding venue trade-only keys and on-chain session keys scoped by `MMMandate`: quotes within width, inventory within limits, skew within bounds, hedge ratio within band, no new risk off-hours when the feed holds, kill on drawdown. Off-venue actions (hedge legs in Stock Tokens, inventory moves) go through the on-chain guard; on-venue quoting is monitored by the risk service, which pulls keys and cancels on breach (and the mandate's venue limits — isolated margin, max position — cap what a rogue key could do).

Earn the fee flow. Daily, the venue settles the builder's taker-fee share; the in-house engine routes taker fees, liquidation fees and spread capture to the book; funding received net of paid accrues to the book. `RevenueRouter` runs the waterfall: expenses (oracle, gas) $\rightarrow$ protocol carry $\rightarrow$ Senior hurdle $\rightarrow$ Junior residual. Losses run the other way: Junior $\rightarrow$ Senior $\rightarrow$ ADL (venue). Every book publishes NAV, inventory, realised/unrealised P&L and limit utilisation live; the daily mark is a signed, receipt-rooted statement.

Trade the markets. Markets chartered through Bookrunner are ordinary perp markets anyone can trade on the venue; the book is the house. Treasuries and funds hedging Stock Token exposure become the natural takers of a well-run stock-perp book.

4. Studio engines reused

- Pool-vs-trader perp engine + attested multi-source TEE oracle + off-hours regime (index held $\rightarrow$ liquidate on margin only) $\rightarrow$ the in-house venue for markets Orderly can't list (RWA sessions, custom indices).
- Deterministic authorization pipeline + session keys $\rightarrow$ `MMMandate` enforcement for on-chain legs.
- Model-jury oracle $\rightarrow$ Risk Committee verdicts.

- Keyless ERC-4626 vault accounting at NAV → tranches.
- Canonical Stock Token registry + multiplier-aware valuer → hedge inventory valuation.
- Hourly Merkle receipts → daily signed marks.

New: `Book` + waterfall, `MarketCharter`, `Orderly` builder adapter (IF account, symbol creation, daily fee settlement), `RevenueRouter`, committee bonding, book dashboards.

5. Token — \$BKRN

- 80 / 10 / 5 / 5. Fresh deployer, multisig, unlinked.
- **Utility:** protocol carry (see §6) → 50% buyback-to-stakers, 50% **syndicate backstop** (covers Senior shortfalls after Junior is exhausted, up to the backstop). Staked \$BKRN required to sponsor a charter (bond, slashed if the sponsor abandons a live book), to sit on the Risk Committee (bonded), and to run a bookrunner agent above the entry inventory tier. Access and bonding, never a revenue claim.

6. Business and fees

- **Protocol carry:** 10% of each book's net fee flow (after venue and oracle costs), taken in the waterfall before Senior. No management fee on capital.
- **Charter fee:** flat USDC fee per charter to cover committee review and oracle setup; refunded if rejected.
- **In-house venue:** taker/maker fees set per charter; the engine's share is the protocol carry only.

7. Launch — two-gate check

- **Wet pond:** equity perps are the fastest-growing derivatives market of 2026; Robinhood Chain has three stock-perp venues and a permissionless listing rail; allocators already buy curator-run risk capital at scale.
- **KOL-tweetable first:** *"Be the house for one stock-perp market: pick the book, pick senior or junior, an agent runs it inside a mandate it can't break — Robinhood Chain."* Launch with **three studio-sponsored books** (NVDA, TSLA, a Stock-Token-index perp) capitalised by studio treasuries, so day one shows live fee flow and marks.
- **Format:** FLASH on RHC; subscription windows for the first three books open at launch; first daily marks the same day.

8. Kill criteria

- Day 14: < \$300k subscribed across the three launch books or < \$25k/day combined venue volume → stop subscription incentives; run the books on studio capital.
- Day 30: any mark reconciliation break vs the venue not explained by an outage → freeze new charters until clean.
- Day 60: < 5 external charters filed → fold to an internal house-vault for studio markets; keep the engine.
- Any *MMM*mandate or waterfall bypass found by the bounty → pause new books, never redemptions.

9. Frictions

- **[competitive]** Orderly or Hyperliquid syndicate their own builder/HLP seats. Counter: we are venue-agnostic and run our own engine; claim the "underwriting syndicate" category now; publish book-level marks they don't.
- **[environmental]** Stock Token float caps hedge inventory. Counter: inventory and skew limits scale with float; index books hedge across names; hedge via other perp venues when the mandate allows.
- **[environmental]** Venue custody (Orderly omnichain vault) is a counterparty exposure. Counter: per-book venue cap, in-house engine for the largest books.
- **[self-induced]** Junior tranche marketed as "high yield." Counter: tranches are described by *seniority and loss order* only; no rates; CI bans the words.

10. What not to say

- Never "APY", "yield", "returns", "target" → **"fee flow", "observed accrual over the mark period", "NAV"**.
- Never "guaranteed", "protected", "insured" for Senior → **"last loss in the waterfall", "backstop up to the pool."**
- Never "we market-make for you" → **"bookrunner agents quote the book under its mandate."** Bookrunner is software; not a fund, adviser, broker or venue operator of record where Orderly is the venue.
- Never name Orderly, Arcus or Chainlink as partners → "listed on X's public contracts."
- No US marketing of stock-perp books (Stock Tokens not for US persons; Robinhood's own perps are a separate, US-only product we never reference).
- Never mention sibling studio products.

11. Honest limits

- On Orderly, the venue holds margin and runs liquidation/ADL; the book's exposure is bounded by its deposits, not eliminated. ADL hits traders in that market only, per the venue's rules.
- `MMMandate` enforces on-chain legs in code and venue quoting by monitoring + key revocation; a venue-side limit (isolated margin, position caps) is the hard stop for a compromised key.
- Senior is last loss, not no loss; the backstop pays up to its balance.
- Feeds hold off-hours; the mandate's off-hours rule exists because quoting against a held print is adverse selection.
- Builder-oracle markets carry our oracle's risk; the oracle is attested and multi-source, and still an oracle.
- Orderly's exact IF minimums, chains and symbol limits are from docs and prior recon; re-verify at build time.

12. Sources

- Orderly Perp Anything introduction: <https://orderly.network/docs/build-on-omnichain/perp-anything/introduction> · blog: <https://orderly.network/blog/create-a-perp-market> · pre-TGE listing: <https://orderly.network/docs/build-on-omnichain/perp-anything/pre-tge-listing>
- Ethena equity basis (TechFlow, 2026-09-25): <https://www.techflowpost.com/en-US/article/34249> · Equity perps and market-neutral tactics (Cryptonomist, 2026-09-25): <https://en.cryptonomist.ch/2026/09/25/equity-perpetual-contracts/>
- Vault curators (Cryptopolitan): <https://www.cryptopolitan.com/vault-curators-become-the-growth-driver-for-defi/>
- Harmonix docs (Hyperliquid vault strategies): <https://harmonixfi.github.io/harmonix-docs-v2/harmonix-docs-v2.html>
- Studio-verified chain facts (RHC venues, Stock Tokens, feeds) as of 2026-09.